

Backgrounds & Borders in CSS

Customize element appearance with colors, images, gradients, and precise borders.

Overview

CSS allows you to customize how elements look and feel by adding backgrounds and borders. You can apply colors, images, gradients, and control borders precisely around elements.

Background Properties

background-color	Sets a solid color behind an element.
background-image	Adds an image as the background. You can use local images or remote URLs.
background-repeat	Controls if the background image repeats.
background-size	Sets the size of the background image.
background-position	Positions the background image within the element.
background-attachment	Controls scroll behavior.

Basic Background Examples

```
div {  
  background-color: lightblue;  
}  
  
body {  
  background-image: url('background.jpg');  
}
```

■ **Tip** Background properties can be used independently or combined through the background shorthand property.

Background Properties in Detail

Control repetition, sizing, positioning, and scrolling behavior.

background-repeat

Controls whether a background image repeats.

```
background-repeat: repeat; /* Default */
background-repeat: no-repeat;
background-repeat: repeat-x; /* Only horizontally */
background-repeat: repeat-y; /* Only vertically */
```

background-size

Sets the size of the background image.

```
background-size: cover; /* Fill container and crop */
background-size: contain; /* Fit image without cropping */
background-size: 100px 200px; /* Custom dimensions */
```

background-position

Positions the background image within the element.

```
background-position: center;
background-position: top right;
background-position: 50% 50%;
```

background-attachment

Controls how the background behaves when the page is scrolled.

```
background-attachment: scroll; /* Default */
background-attachment: fixed; /* Stays in place during scroll */
```

Background Shorthand & Borders

Combine background settings and begin defining element boundaries.

Shorthand Property: background

You can combine background properties in one line.

```
div {  
  background: url('bg.jpg') no-repeat center center / cover;  
}
```

Border Properties

border-width	Sets the thickness of the border.
border-style	Defines the style of the border.
border-color	Sets the color of the border.
border	Shorthand for combining border width, style, and color.
Individual sides	Lets you control the top, right, bottom, and left borders separately.
border-radius	Rounds the corners of an element.

Border Width

```
div {  
  border-width: 3px;  
}
```

Border Style

```
border-style: solid; /* Common */  
border-style: dashed;  
border-style: dotted;  
border-style: double;  
border-style: none;
```

Border Styling

Use color, shorthand syntax, individual sides, and rounded corners.

Border Color & Shorthand

The border-color property sets the color of the border. The border shorthand combines width, style, and color.

```
border-color: darkgray;

div {
  border: 2px solid #333;
}
```

Individual Sides

Each side of an element can have its own border width, style, and color.

```
border-top: 1px solid black;
border-right: 2px dashed red;
border-bottom: none;
border-left: 3px dotted green;
```

Border Radius

border-radius rounds the corners of an element. Percentages can also be used to create circular shapes.

```
button {
  border-radius: 10px;
}
```

■ **Tip** A 50% border-radius can create a perfect circle when applied to a square element, such as a square image.

Quick Reference

A compact review of the background and border properties covered in this lesson.

Background Properties

<code>background-color</code>	Solid background color
<code>background-image</code>	Background image
<code>background-repeat</code>	Image repetition
<code>background-size</code>	Image dimensions / cover / contain
<code>background-position</code>	Image placement
<code>background-attachment</code>	Scroll behavior
<code>background</code>	Background shorthand

Border Properties

<code>border-width</code>	Border thickness
<code>border-style</code>	Border appearance
<code>border-color</code>	Border color
<code>border</code>	Border shorthand
<code>border-top/right/bottom/left</code>	Individual side control
<code>border-radius</code>	Rounded corners / circular shapes

Summary

- Use background properties to add color, images, and gradients.
- Borders help separate and define content.
- Use border-radius to soften corners and create modern designs.

```
img {  
  border-radius: 50%; /* Perfect circle for square images */  
}
```

■ **Tip** Remember the distinction: backgrounds decorate the area behind an element, while borders define the element's visible boundary.